DEPARTMENT 1 · DEVELOPMENT AND IT · PROFESSION 5

Photo editor

Profession 5 of 10 in Development and IT.

What the profession means

A photo editor improves and prepares photographs: exposure, colour, retouching, background cleaning and resizing for print or web.

What professionals do every day

Culls shots, adjusts exposure and colour, retouches, removes distractions, keeps colour consistent across a set, and exports to the client's specifications.

Why businesses hire them, and what problems they solve

Product and portrait photos sell products and people. Clean, consistent images increase trust and conversions.

- Inconsistent colour across a product catalogue.
- Distracting backgrounds and blemishes.
- Files too large for the web or too small for print.

Skills you need

- Exposure, white balance and colour grading.
- Selection and masking.
- Retouching with restraint.
- Export sizes and formats (JPG, PNG, WebP).

Tools (free and paid)

Tool	What it is for	Free option	Paid option	Official link (not checked live)
Adobe Lightroom	Batch editing and colour	Trial	Subscription	www.adobe.com/products/photoshop-lightroom.html
Adobe Photoshop	Retouching and compositing	Trial	Subscription	www.adobe.com/products/photoshop.html
GIMP	Open-source retouching	Free	Free	www.gimp.org
Snapseed	Phone editing	Free	Free	snapseed.online

Learning sequence: beginner, intermediate, advanced

Level	What you can do when you finish
Beginner	Correct exposure and white balance on ten product photos.
Intermediate	Remove a background cleanly.

Advanced	Batch-edit a catalogue of 50 items with one preset.

Projects by level

- **Beginner:** Catalogue of 50 products.
- **Intermediate:** Portrait retouching with a natural look.
- **Advanced:** Real estate photo set.

Client-ready portfolio project

A 20-photo product set for a fictional shop: consistent colour, backgrounds cleaned, and web and print exports with a checklist.

Worked example

Worked example. A white mug photographed under warm light is corrected by setting the white balance from a grey card in the shot, then matching the whole set with one preset.

Assignment with full solution

ASSIGNMENT

Consistent 20-photo product set

Business problem: A shop needs 20 product photos with one look.

Steps

1. Set white balance and exposure on the first image.
2. Create a preset and apply it to the set.
3. Check each image against the colour reference.
4. Export web (2000 px, sRGB) and print (300 dpi) versions.

Expected output: A set of images and an export log.

SOLUTION (ANSWER KEY)

One reference shot sets the colour; the preset keeps the set consistent. Web exports use sRGB so colours match across screens.

Common mistakes

- Over-smoothing skin or product textures.
- Editing on an uncalibrated screen.
- Forgetting to check colour profiles on export.
- No backup of originals.

Freelancing opportunities

- Product photo editing for online shops.

- Real estate and event photo sets.
- Briefs for 'photo editing', 'retouching', 'product photos'.

Learning resources

LEARNING RESOURCES (VERIFY BEFORE USE)

- Adobe Lightroom help

Part of **Master Freelancing: Design and Creative**. Back to the chapter list on skillnavora.in · Open the full textbook. Official links in this chapter were not checked live; confirm before relying on them.